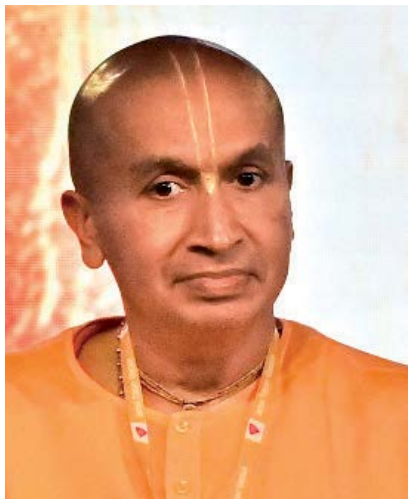
K. ASIF



GAURANGA DAS

ISKCON monk, spiritual teacher and motivational speaker

ARUN KUMAR



HENRIQUE JORGE

Founder & CEO, ETER9

HARDIK CHHABRA



SAJEEV NAIR

Founder, Vieroots Wellness Solutions, Limoverse, and World Biohack Summit

THE ETERNAL DEBATE

Artificial Intelligence is advancing fast enough to start saving human memories and thoughts forever, leading to an era of digital immortality. These AI-created clones can simulate human behaviour, learning from their human counterparts. Once trained well enough, an 'eternal' can become a path to spiritual changes by giving us deep insights into life, memory and perspectives. Tech entrepreneur Henrique Jorge has been working at ETER9 to achieve this, a world where these clones will be able to ensure that a human being is remembered forever. "Imagine, Einstein could live in this platform and teach the students directly in the digital way," he explained during a session at the India Today Conclave.

Such AI technology is also becoming relevant for biohacking, which can use the deep machine understanding of a human being to push the boundaries of longevity and improve health outcomes by "switching off" certain harmful genes in the body. "What's the harm in living absolutely healthy for 120 years and contributing the best to society?" asked Sajeev Nair, a fellow panelist working in the field of biohacking.

But to have a digital version of yourself frozen into a machine forever does raise many concerns about ethics, authenticity and privacy. The greatest concern being of hacked data leaks and humans becoming controlled by the machines themselves. As ISKCON monk Gauranga Das, who added a spiritual dimension to the debate, said: "We need the assistance of machines, but the values and morality should always remain human." This was reiterated by the other two, who, too, felt that at the end of the day, the dividing line between human and machine should remain. While digital platforms and technology create opportunities and ease of convenience, the human soul cannot be imprisoned within one. And, according to Das, that soul only belongs to the Supreme. ■

> **"We are not against technology, we are not against modernisation, we are not against digital, but the question is, who is controlling whom?**
> **–Gauranga Das**
>
> **Imagine my clone, if I'm a bad person, my digital version is also a bad person. But there are tools and regulations that could stop this**
> **–Henrique Jorge**
>
> **When we are talking about optimisation, it's not just the body, it's the body, brain and the mind.... With today's technology, you can do a much better job**
> **–Sajeev Nair"**